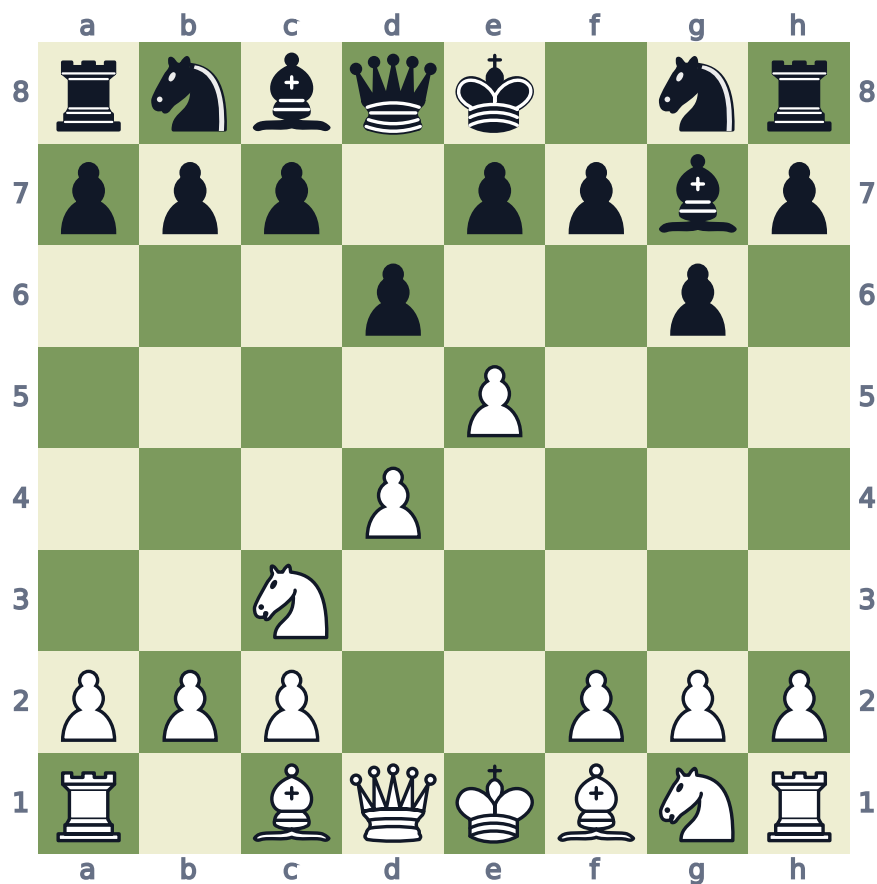


Hippo Tactics, Traps, and Defensive Resources

Breakthrough calculation, long-diagonal tactics, king safety, and emergency defense



Train tactical decisions from the taught Hippo positions and learn why compact positions still demand precise calculation.

36 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Train tactical decisions from the taught Hippo positions and learn why compact positions still demand precise calculation.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 36 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

A cramped position magnifies the cost of one opened line.

PRINCIPLE 2

Long diagonals can become tactical after a single central exchange.

PRINCIPLE 3

Pawn breaks may attack pieces by discovery rather than directly.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

The f-file can serve either king depending on who opens it.

PRINCIPLE 5

Loose pieces behind a pawn chain remain loose when the chain moves.

PRINCIPLE 6

Calculate checks, captures, and threats before applying a strategic Hippo rule.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

TACTICAL PROTOCOL

How to solve opening tactics without guessing

STEP 1

Update the board after the last move: new attacks, lost defenses, and opened lines.

STEP 2

List every legal check, major capture, and direct threat for both sides.

STEP 3

Identify loose pieces, pinned defenders, overloaded pieces, and exposed kings.

STEP 4

Calculate the opponent's strongest forcing reply before choosing.

STEP 5

At the endpoint, count material and evaluate king safety, development, and center.

TACTICAL TEST 01 OF 36

White advances e5 early



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 02 OF 36

Emergency reaction to e5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 03 OF 36

Bird Opening



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 04 OF 36

Botvinnik English setup



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

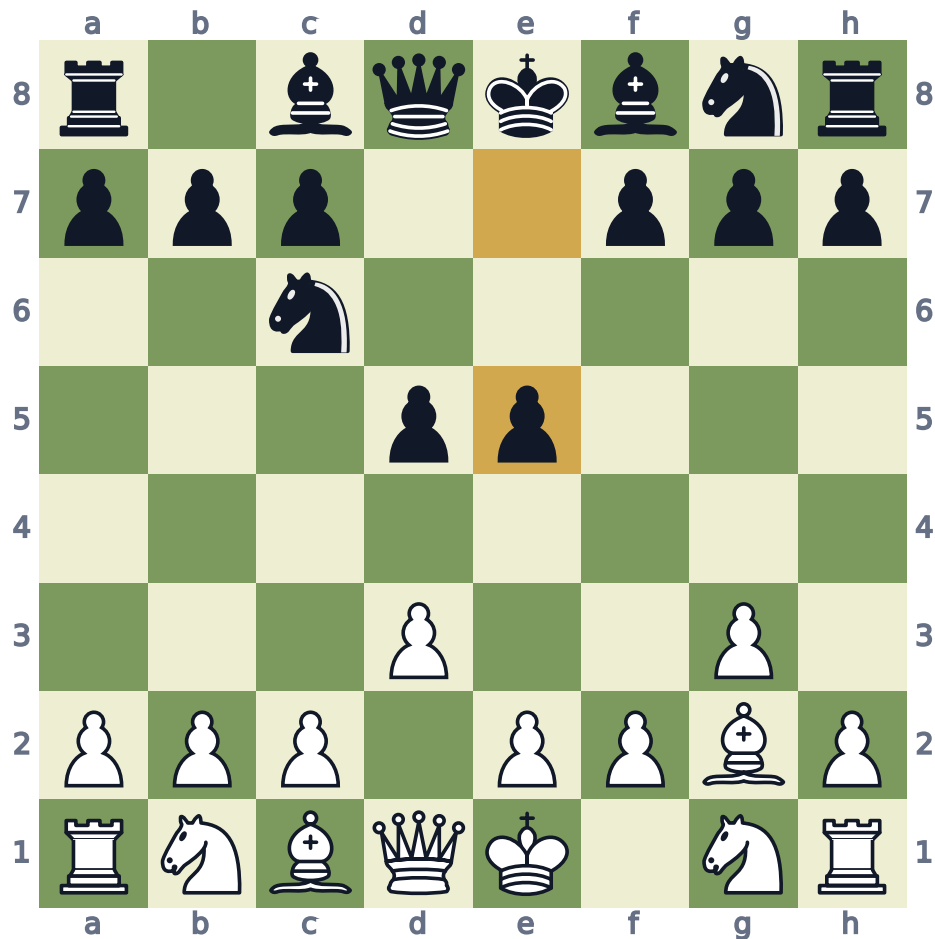
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 05 OF 36

White Hippo vs immediate d5-e5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 06 OF 36

Austrian center and f5 counterstrike

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

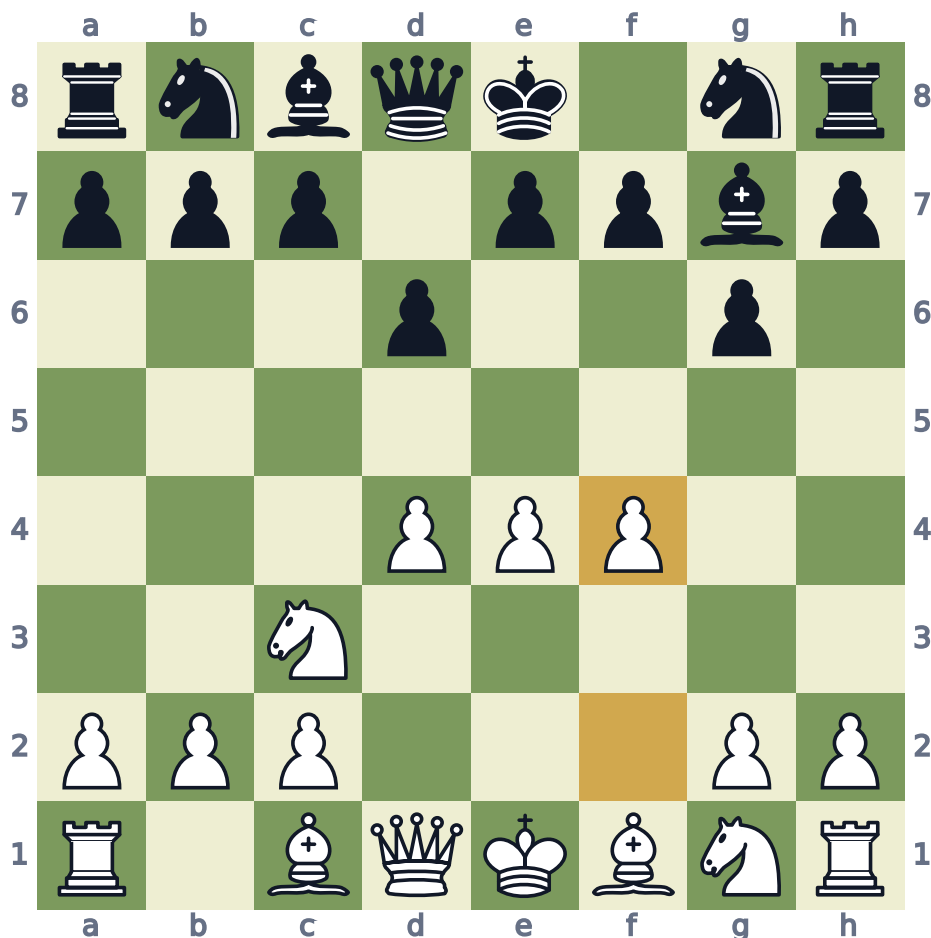
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 07 OF 36

e5 against the Austrian center

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 08 OF 36

c5 against f4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

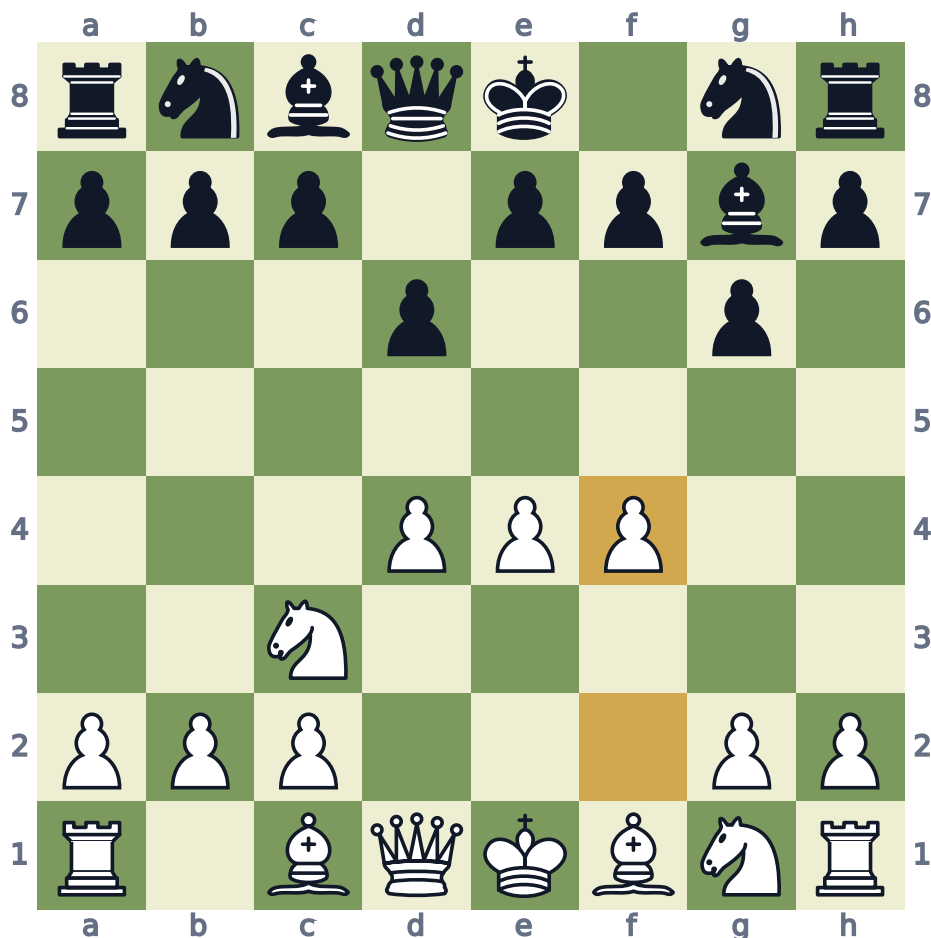
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 09 OF 36

f5 against the Austrian center

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 10 OF 36

Pawn storm with f5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

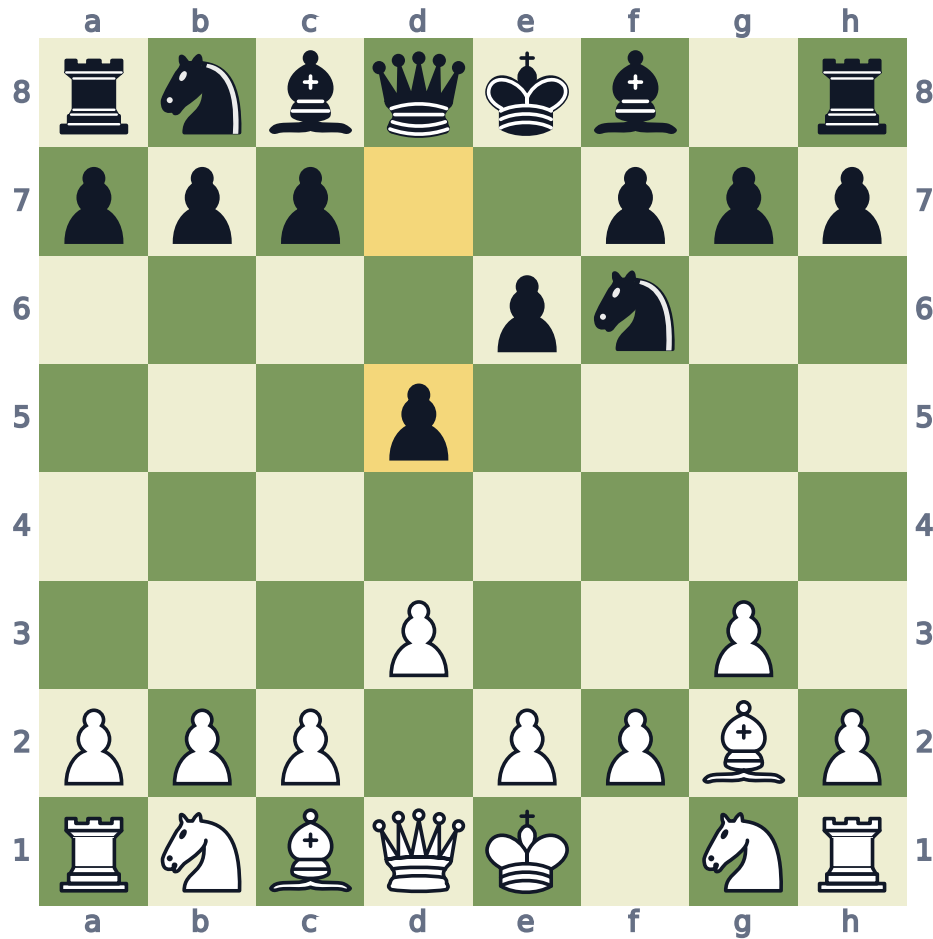
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 11 OF 36

White Hippo vs Queen's Indian shell



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

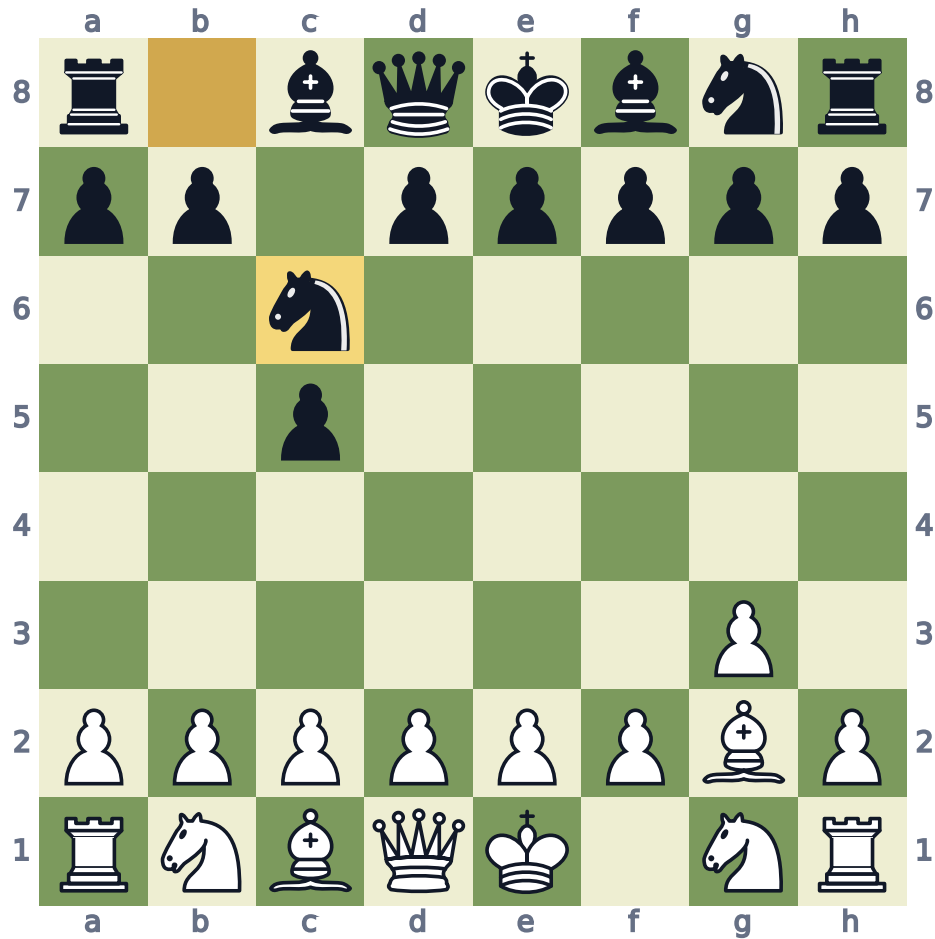
White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 12 OF 36

White Hippo vs English defense



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 13 OF 36

White Hippo vs French shell



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 14 OF 36

Jobava-style Nc3 and Bf4

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 15 OF 36

English fianchetto

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 16 OF 36

e5 against a rook on e1

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 17 OF 36

e5 against long castling

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 18 OF 36

c5 against the classical e4 center

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 19 OF 36

When b5 should be restrained



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 20 OF 36

Reroute the e7 knight



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 21 OF 36

Improve the c1 bishop before breaking



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

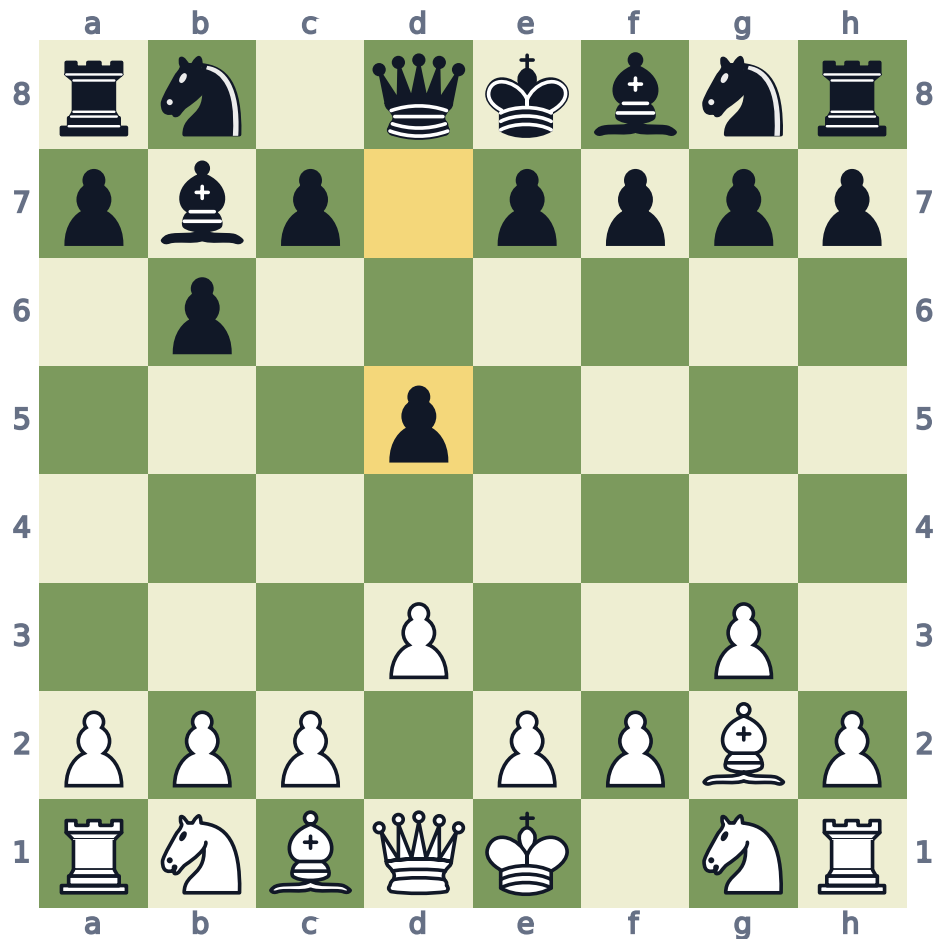
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 22 OF 36

White Hippo vs Owen-style b6



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 23 OF 36

White closes with d5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 24 OF 36

London System



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 25 OF 36

Torre bishop on g5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 26 OF 36

London space clamp with d5



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 27 OF 36

White Hippo vs classical center



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 28 OF 36

White Hippo vs e5-d5

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 29 OF 36

Catalan fianchetto

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

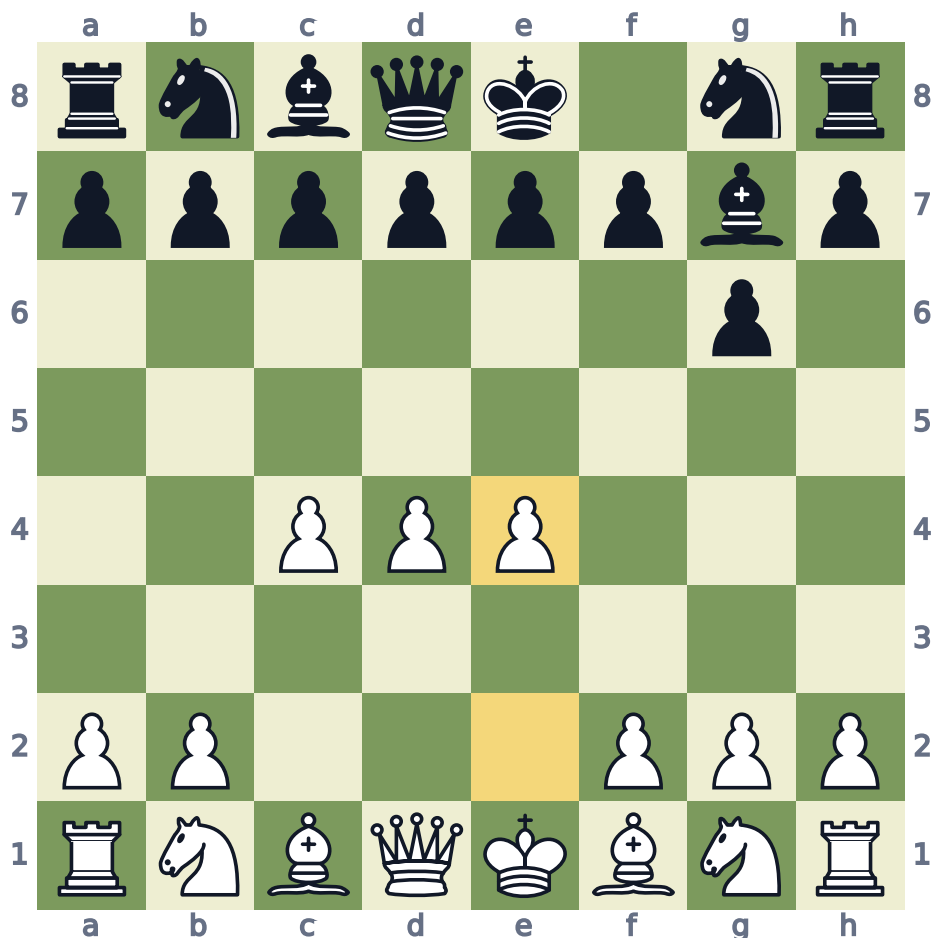
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 30 OF 36

Early f4 changes the order

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

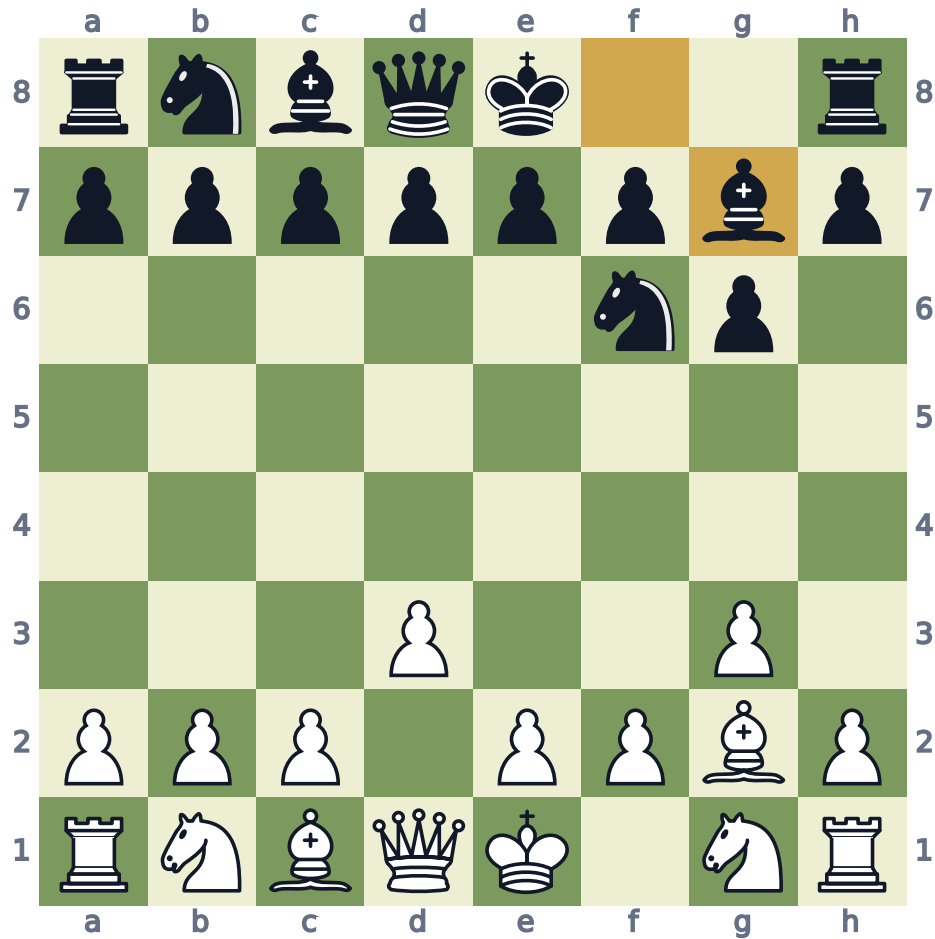
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SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 31 OF 36

White Hippo vs King's Indian



CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER

White to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 32 OF 36

e5 against the classical d4 center

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

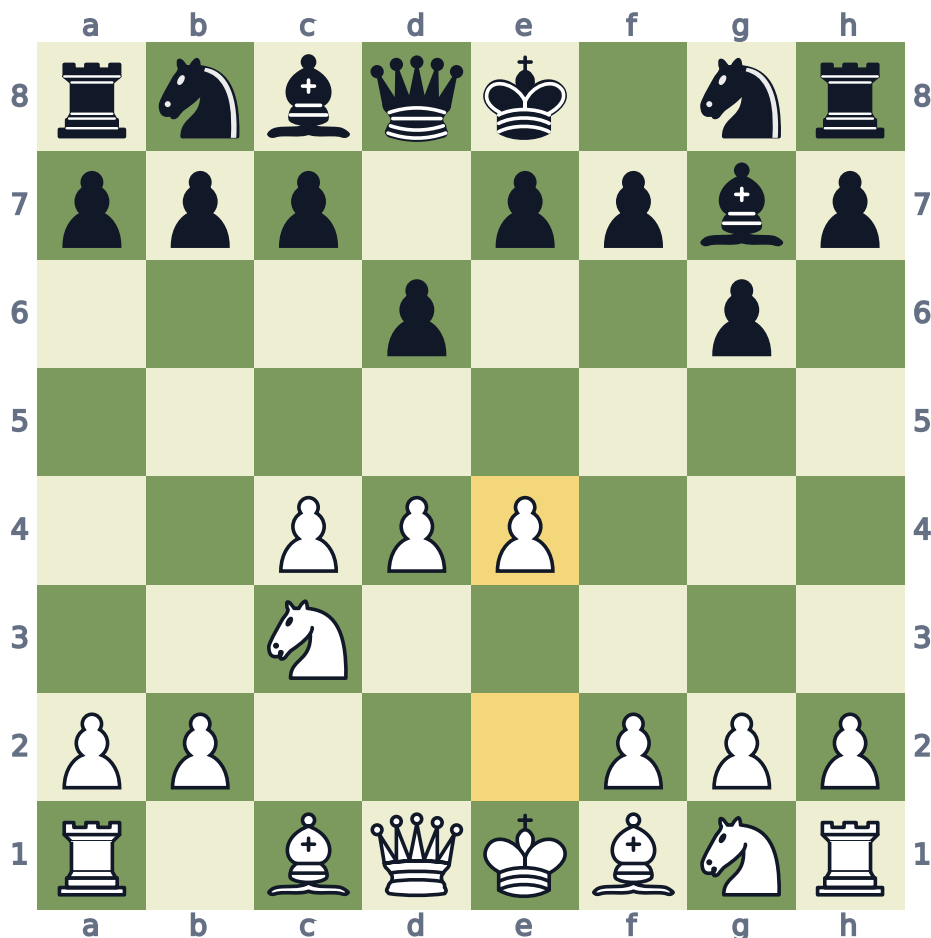
Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 33 OF 36

e5 with White's c-pawn committed

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 34 OF 36

c5 against the broad d4 center

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 35 OF 36

c5 against long-castle development

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

TACTICAL TEST 36 OF 36

c5 after Be2

**CALCULATE BEFORE REVEALING THE ANSWER**

Black to move. First identify the opponent's threat or tactical idea. List checks, captures, and forcing threats. Choose a move, calculate at least three plies, and state whether the solution is tactical, developmental, or a move-order prevention.

SCORING

2 recognition | 2 candidates | 3 calculation | 2 endpoint | 1 explanation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Tactical solutions begin here

SCORING HONESTY

A correct first move earns at most 2 points if the line or reason was missing. If the engine move differs from the repertoire move, record why: tactics, transposition, or a small positional preference. The goal is accurate thinking, not worship of a number.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 1-3

01. WHITE ADVANCES E5 EARLY

Engine move: dxe5. Line: 1. dxe5 dxe5 2. Qxd1+ Nxd1 3. Bxe5 Nf3 4. Bd6 Ne3 5. Nf6 Nc4. Evaluation: -1.14 for White (Black is clearly better). Positional purpose: Eliminate the advanced pawn or pressure it before completing the Hippo shell. Warning: The e5 pawn can cramp both knights if Black treats it as harmless.

02. EMERGENCY REACTION TO E5

Engine move: dxe5. Line: 1. dxe5 dxe5 2. Qxd1+ Nxd1 3. Bxe5 Nf3 4. Bd6 Ne3 5. Nf6 Nc4. Evaluation: -1.14 for White (Black is clearly better). Positional purpose: Attack or exchange the advanced pawn before it freezes the shell. Warning: Nxe5 tactics may fail if the knight is pinned or underdefended.

03. BIRD OPENING

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 Nc3 2. Nc6 a4 3. a6 Bc4 4. e6 O-O. Evaluation: -0.04 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Target e4 and prepare f5 or e5 against the reversed Austrian center. Warning: White's extra tempo supports e5 and f5.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 4-6

04. BOTVINNIK ENGLISH SETUP

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 g3 2. a6 d3 3. Nc6 Bg2 4. b5 Nge2 5. Rb8 O-O. Evaluation: -0.29 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Restrict d4, develop compactly, and aim for f5 or c5. Warning: White may use f4-f5 with extra tempo.

05. WHITE HIPPO VS IMMEDIATE D5-E5

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Nf6 2. O-O Bc5 3. Bg5 Be7 4. Nfd2 O-O. Evaluation: -0.28 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Build toward Bb2 and e4, using the extra tempo to challenge Black's center. Warning: d4 can close space and leave White cramped.

06. AUSTRIAN CENTER AND F5 COUNTERSTRIKE

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Challenge e4 before White's e5-f5 expansion takes over the kingside. Warning: exf5 can open lines against Black's king and e6.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 7-9

07. E5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Hit d4 before White advances e5 and f5. Warning: fxe5 can open the f-file and leave e6 sensitive.

08. C5 AGAINST F4

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Attack d4 before White's kingside expansion becomes forcing. Warning: d5 can close the queenside and permit f5.

09. F5 AGAINST THE AUSTRIAN CENTER

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Attack e4 and contest the kingside before White plays f5. Warning: exf5 can expose Black's king and the e6 pawn.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 10-12

10. PAWN STORM WITH F5

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.69 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Choose between exf5, e5, or queenside counterplay from calculation. Warning: Opening the e- or g-file can expose an uncastled king.

11. WHITE HIPPO VS QUEEN'S INDIAN SHELL

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Be7 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd5 Nxd5. Evaluation: +0.04 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Develop harmoniously and use c4 or e4 before Black owns the center. Warning: d4 may fix White in a passive structure.

12. WHITE HIPPO VS ENGLISH DEFENSE

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 g6 2. e3 Bg7 3. Ne2 e6. Evaluation: +0.36 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare c4 or e4 while keeping both knights flexible. Warning: Black can gain comfortable central equality with d4.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 13-15

13. WHITE HIPPO VS FRENCH SHELL

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 c5 2. O-O Be7 3. e4 Nc6 4. Bf4 O-O 5. Ne5 Nxe5. Evaluation: +0.06 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Use e4 or c4 to prevent a free central occupation. Warning: d4 can close the center on Black's terms.

14. JOBAVA-STYLE NC3 AND BF4

Engine move: d5. Line: 1. d5 Qd2 2. c5 dxc5 3. e5 Bg3 4. d4. Evaluation: +0.19 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Keep the king flexible and seek c5 against White's queenside castling plan. Warning: Nb5, h4, and e5 can create tactics before Black castles.

15. ENGLISH FIANCHETTO

Engine move: e5. Line: 1. e5 Nf3 2. Nc6 Bg2 3. Nge7 d3 4. O-O O-O 5. d6 Rb1. Evaluation: +0.20 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Transpose to a Hippo after White occupies e4 and prepare c5 or e5. Warning: White can play d4 in one move and obtain a large center.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 16-18

16. E5 AGAINST A ROOK ON E1

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Challenge d4 while using piece support to survive e-file tactics. Warning: dxe5 can expose the rook against the e-pawn or queen.

17. E5 AGAINST LONG CASTLING

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Open central lines before White's kingside pawn storm becomes fast. Warning: d5 can close the center and free White to attack the king.

18. C5 AGAINST THE CLASSICAL E4 CENTER

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Pressure d4 and invite a structure Black can attack on the c-file. Warning: d5 may gain space and support e5.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 19-21

19. WHEN B5 SHOULD BE RESTRAINED

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use b6 and Bb7 instead of forcing b5 into White's a4 restraint. Warning: White may use a5 to fix queenside weaknesses.

20. REROUTE THE E7 KNIGHT

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use h6 to ask the bishop a question and prepare a knight route to f5 or g6. Warning: g5 can weaken the king and trap Black's own pieces.

21. IMPROVE THE C1 BISHOP BEFORE BREAKING

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3. Evaluation: +0.64 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Develop the last piece and increase control of e5 before the center changes. Warning: Bf4 can be hit by e5 with tempo if timing is wrong.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 22-24

22. WHITE HIPPO VS OWEN-STYLE B6

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 Nf6 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. d4 e6 4. e4 Bb4+ 5. Bd2 Bxd2+. Evaluation: +0.33 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use Black's d5 commitment to complete the shell and prepare e4 or c4. Warning: Black may use c5 before White challenges the center.

23. WHITE CLOSES WITH D5

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Nf3 3. Nbd7 O-O. Evaluation: -0.03 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Challenge the closed chain before White consolidates a space advantage. Warning: After exd5, White may gain e-file pressure and a protected passer.

24. LONDON SYSTEM

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 c3 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. Nf6 Nc3 4. Qb6. Evaluation: +0.09 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Develop without chasing Bf4 and prepare e5 or c5 against d4. Warning: White may build e4 with Nbd2 and c3 if Black waits.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 25-27

25. TORRE BISHOP ON G5

Engine move: h6. Line: 1. h6 Bf4 2. c5 c3 3. Nf6 dxc5 4. O-O e3 5. b6 cxb6. Evaluation: -0.08 for White (equal).

Positional purpose: Build the shell while asking whether the bishop's pin has any concrete force. Warning: e5 can exploit the bishop's pressure and Black's cramped knights.

26. LONDON SPACE CLAMP WITH D5

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 c3 2. cxd4 cxd4 3. Nf6 Nc3 4. Qb6. Evaluation: +0.09 for White (equal). Positional

purpose: Prepare exd5 or e5 and reorganize before the closed center becomes permanent. Warning: White can support e4 and squeeze the compact knights.

27. WHITE HIPPO VS CLASSICAL CENTER

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. e4 dxe4 3. dxe4 h6 4. Nc3. Evaluation: -0.33 for White (Black is slightly

better). Positional purpose: Complete the flexible shell, then challenge the center with e4 or c4. Warning: Black can gain too much space if White keeps waiting.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 28-30

28. WHITE HIPPO VS E5-D5

Engine move: Nf3. Line: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. e4 dxe4 3. dxe4 h6 4. Nc3. Evaluation: -0.33 for White (Black is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare Bb2 and choose e4 or c4 based on Black's support. Warning: f5 can start a kingside attack before White is coordinated.

29. CATALAN FIANCHETTO

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 dxc5 2. Qa5+ Bd2 3. Qxc5 Nc3 4. Nf6 Rc1 5. Nc6 b3. Evaluation: +0.45 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Prepare Bb7 and central contact while respecting the long diagonal. Warning: d5 or e4 can give White lasting space and pressure.

30. EARLY F4 CHANGES THE ORDER

Engine move: d6. Line: 1. d6 Nc3 2. Nf6 Be2 3. O-O Nf3 4. e5 O-O 5. Nc6 d5. Evaluation: +0.63 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Secure the king and prepare f5 or e5 before slower queenside moves. Warning: f5 may meet e5 and open a dangerous diagonal.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 31-33

31. WHITE HIPPO VS KING'S INDIAN

Engine move: c4. Line: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Qb3 Nb6 4. Qc2 O-O 5. Nf3 e5. Evaluation: +0.16 for White (equal). Positional purpose: Prepare Bb2 and choose c4 or e4 according to Black's center. Warning: Black may attack with f5 before White creates counterplay.

32. E5 AGAINST THE CLASSICAL D4 CENTER

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4. Evaluation: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Attack d4, free the queen and knights, and force White to define the center. Warning: d5 gains space and can leave Black's pieces short of squares.

33. E5 WITH WHITE'S C-PAWN COMMITTED

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4. Evaluation: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Fix or exchange the center, then use the c-pawn's commitment to choose queenside play. Warning: d5 may create a space clamp and a protected e4 pawn.

SOLUTIONS

Tests 34-36

34. C5 AGAINST THE BROAD D4 CENTER

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4. Evaluation: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Attack d4 and open a queenside route for the rook and queen. Warning: d5 can gain a Benoni-style space advantage.

35. C5 AGAINST LONG-CASTLE DEVELOPMENT

Engine move: Nf6. Line: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4. Evaluation: +0.56 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Open queenside lines before White decides where to place the king. Warning: d5 can lock the c-file and give White time for h4.

36. C5 AFTER BE2

Engine move: c5. Line: 1. c5 d5 2. Bxc3+ bxc3 3. e5 f4 4. f5 Nf3 5. fxe4 Ng5. Evaluation: +0.65 for White (White is slightly better). Positional purpose: Use the safe king as permission to challenge the center immediately. Warning: d5 can cramp Ne7 and Nd7 together.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.